

GENERAL ENGLISH (IDIOMS & PHRASES SERIES)

PRACTICE SHEET HARD LEVEL (SET 2) / ADVANCED IDIOMS & MEANINGS (30 QUESTIONS)

1. What is the meaning of the idiom: "An apple of discord"

- (A) A subject or cause of dispute, envy, or rivalry
- (B) A contaminated piece of fruit causing widespread illness
- (C) A rare horticultural variety grown in ancient orchards
- (D) A symbolic offering given during peace treaty negotiations

2. What is the meaning of the idiom: "At loggerheads"

- (A) Engaged in a stubborn dispute or fierce disagreement
- (B) Confused by conflicting navigational instructions
- (C) Sailing vessels caught in violent oceanic squalls
- (D) Working cooperatively on complex maritime projects

3. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Back-seat driver"

- (A) Someone who offers unwanted advice or tries to control a situation from behind
- (B) A licensed chauffeur operating luxury sedan vehicles
- (C) An automotive engineer testing autopilot navigation software
- (D) A backseat passenger sleeping during long road trips

4. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Bite the bullet"

- (A) To force oneself to endure an unpleasant or painful situation
- (B) To consume hard ammunition during military survival drills
- (C) To react aggressively when provoked by political rivals
- (D) To accept a financial loss without demanding compensation

5. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Burn one's bridges"

- (A) To destroy relationships, connections, or paths to return irrevocably
- (B) To commit arson against municipal engineering infrastructure
- (C) To sever financial ties with venture capital investors
- (D) To isolate oneself from society during personal crises

6. What is the meaning of the idiom: "By the skin of one's teeth"

- (A) By a very narrow margin; barely escaping disaster
- (B) Through extreme physical endurance and athletic training
- (C) Utilizing dishonest shortcuts to pass examinations
- (D) Relying entirely on luck rather than professional skill

7. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cast pearls before swine"

- (A) To offer something valuable to someone who cannot appreciate its worth
- (B) To waste luxury ornaments on agricultural livestock
- (C) To distribute wealth indiscriminately among impoverished populations
- (D) To perform noble deeds in front of ungrateful audiences

8. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Chimerical scheme"

- (A) Existing only as the product of unchecked imagination; fantastically improbable
- (B) A brilliant scientific breakthrough published in journals
- (C) A complex architectural blueprint designed for skyscrapers
- (D) A sophisticated corporate restructuring master plan

9. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cry wolf"

- (A) To raise a false alarm, thereby losing credibility when real danger occurs
- (B) To complain loudly about minor physical discomforts
- (C) To mourn publicly over catastrophic financial losses
- (D) To provoke aggressive retaliation from powerful adversaries

10. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cut to the chase"

- (A) To get straight to the point without wasting time on preliminaries
- (B) To pursue fleeing suspects through crowded urban streets

11. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Dark horse"

- (A) A little-known competitor who unexpectedly wins or achieves prominence
- (B) An undercover agent infiltrating criminal syndicates
- (C) A mysterious equestrian racer with unknown pedigree
- (D) A political candidate supported by extremist factions

12. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Dog in the manger"

- (A) Someone who prevents others from using something they cannot use themselves
- (B) A cruel caretaker mistreating animals on agricultural farms
- (C) A selfish business owner hoarding resources from employees
- (D) An aggressive watchdog guarding corporate real estate

13. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Eighth wonder"

- (A) Something extraordinary, magnificent, or unprecedented in nature
- (B) An ancient archaeological ruin discovered recently
- (C) A monumental architectural failure costing billions
- (D) A legendary natural phenomenon occurring rarely

14. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Feather in one's cap"

- (A) An achievement to be proud of; a notable distinction
- (B) A decorative accessory worn during military parades
- (C) A symbolic promotion granted to junior executives
- (D) A financial bonus awarded for exceptional performance

15. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Fly in the ointment"

- (A) A minor drawback or annoyance that spoils an otherwise pleasant situation
- (B) A chemical contaminant found in pharmaceutical creams
- (C) An unexpected obstacle halting construction projects
- (D) A structural flaw ruining an artistic masterpiece

16. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Gall and wormwood"

- (A) Source of extreme bitterness, resentment, or deep humiliation
- (B) Toxic botanical poisons used in ancient assassinations
- (C) Unpleasant medicinal herbs prescribed for fevers
- (D) Harsh insults exchanged during political debates

17. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Gild the lily"

- (A) To adorn something unnecessarily or try to improve what is already perfect
- (B) To apply gold plating onto inexpensive metallic artifacts
- (C) To exaggerate financial profits in corporate earnings reports
- (D) To spend lavishly on luxury floral decorations

18. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Halcyon days"

- (A) A period of idyllic peace, prosperity, and happy memories
- (B) Long summer vacation breaks enjoyed by students
- (C) Calm meteorological conditions at sea during autumn
- (D) Economic boom periods experienced by industrialized nations

19. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Iron hand in a velvet glove"

- (A) Firm, unyielding authority masked by a polite or gentle exterior
- (B) A dictator ruling nations through tyrannical suppression
- (C) Protective garments worn by industrial metalworkers
- (D) Diplomatic negotiations backed by military threats

20. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Leap in the dark"

- (A) A hazardous venture undertaken with complete uncertainty of outcome
- (B) A nocturnal parachute jump conducted by special forces
- (C) A speculative investment made without financial auditing
- (D) A reckless decision made during emotional distress

21. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Lion's share"

- (A) The largest and best portion of a shared resource
 (C) Corporate dividends distributed among senior executives

- (B) The hunting spoils captured by dominant predators
 (D) The majority vote won by incumbent politicians

22. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Mare's nest"

- (A) A false discovery or illusory illusion that appears important at first
 (C) A stable housing shelter built for breeding horses

- (B) A chaotic workplace environment lacking organization
 (D) A complicated bureaucratic puzzle stalling legislation

23. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Oil on troubled waters"

- (A) An action taken to soothe anger, pacify disputes, or restore harmony
 (C) Bribes paid to silence protesting labor unions

- (B) A chemical spill polluting marine coastal environments
 (D) Diplomatic talks failing to resolve international conflicts

24. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Pass the buck"

- (A) To shift responsibility or blame onto someone else
 (C) To transfer financial assets across offshore accounts

- (B) To gamble money during high-stakes poker matches
 (D) To delegate administrative duties to junior staff

25. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Pyrrhic victory"

- (A) A win achieved at such a devastating cost that it amounts to defeat
 (C) A championship title stripped due to doping violations

- (B) A brilliant military strategy executed by ancient generals
 (D) A courtroom verdict won through technical loopholes

26. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Rest on one's laurels"

- (A) To become complacent and stop striving after past success
 (C) To celebrate career milestones with grand banquets

- (B) To retire from professional sports after winning championships
 (D) To sleep soundly after completing difficult projects

27. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Salt of the earth"

- (A) A person of great reliability, honesty, and fundamental goodness
 (C) Miners extracting mineral resources from subterranean deposits

- (B) Agricultural laborers working on rural plantations
 (D) Founders of charitable organizations assisting the poor

28. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Take the bull by the horns"

- (A) To confront a difficult situation directly and courageously
 (C) To seize control of corporate leadership by force

- (B) To participate in dangerous rodeo sports events
 (D) To wrestle with aggressive political opponents

29. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Throw down the gauntlet"

- (A) To issue a formal challenge or provoke an opponent into a contest
 (C) To discard heavy protective gear on battlefields

- (B) To surrender unconditionally during military conflicts
 (D) To reject partnership offers from corporate rivals

30. What is the meaning of the idiom: "White elephant"

- (A) A possession that is useless, expensive to maintain, or troublesome
 (C) An extravagant gift given during holiday celebrations

- (B) A rare albino animal protected in royal sanctuaries
 (D) An obsolete computer system used in government offices

ANSWER KEY (Q1 - Q30)

Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans
1	(A)	6	(A)	11	(A)	16	(A)	21	(A)	26	(A)
2	(A)	7	(A)	12	(A)	17	(A)	22	(A)	27	(A)
3	(A)	8	(A)	13	(A)	18	(A)	23	(A)	28	(A)
4	(A)	9	(A)	14	(A)	19	(A)	24	(A)	29	(A)